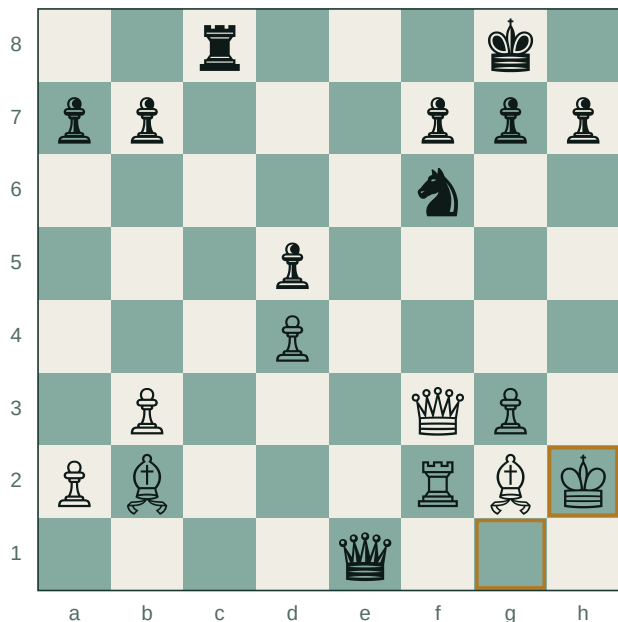


Attraction tactics: Black, move 23

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 23.Kh2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Qxf2 24. Qxf2 Ng4+ 25. Kg1 Nxf2

23...Qxf2 The queen captures the rook on f2. From f2 it attacks queen on f3, bishop on g2 and bishop on b2. Recorded reply: **24.Qxf2**.

24...Ng4+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From g4 it attacks king on h2 and queen on f2. Recorded reply: **25.Kg1**.

25...Nxf2 The knight captures the queen on f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.